RESEARCH GUIDE · 10 OCTOBER 2026

Values Alignment Conferences & Workshops

A source-linked review of venues and papers published, presented, or accepted during the preceding 12 months — with paraphrased abstracts and analytical summaries.

REVIEW WINDOW
10 October 2025–10 October 2026

INCLUDED
6 venues · 13 papers

CORE LENS
Human values, pluralism, personalization, measurement, and long-horizon alignment

STATUS
Conference occurrence is separated from paper acceptance

SCOPE & METHOD

How to read this guide

“Values alignment” is used narrowly: work must study how AI systems represent, elicit, aggregate, prioritize, measure, or remain faithful to human values.

Each entry contains

- **Venue facts:** name, date, location, organizing or sponsoring body, and program context.
- **Abstract:** a concise paraphrase of purpose, method, and reported findings.
- **Summary:** an independent reading of contribution and limitation.
- **Status:** conference paper, spotlight, oral, workshop paper, or accepted paper.

01 · NeurIPS 2025
Pluralistic steering and deep-value generalization

02 · AAAI-26
Fuzzy aggregation and multi-value methods

03 · ICLR 2026
Revealed values and personalized RLHF

04 · Lifelong Agents
Goal drift and contextual safety memory

05 · ACM FAccT 2026
Empirical preference plurality

06 · AIES 2026
Fiduciary duties for assistant alignment

Boundary note

The AIES event occurs 12–14 October 2026, just after the cutoff, but its selected paper had already been accepted and publicly posted. A short BiAlign 2025 predecessor section is explicitly labeled outside the strict window.

VENUE 01

NeurIPS 2025 — 39th Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems

DATE
2–7 December 2025 (San Diego); 30 November–5 December 2025 (Mexico City)

LOCATION
San Diego Convention Center, USA; Hilton Mexico City Reforma, Mexico

ORGANIZING / SPONSORING BODY
Neural Information Processing Systems Foundation

VENUE RECORD
Open source

Large peer-reviewed ML conference. The 2025 program included main, datasets-and-benchmarks, position, and journal tracks.

Counterfactual Reasoning for Steerable Pluralistic Value Alignment of Large Language Models

Hanze Guo, Jing Yao, Xiao Zhou, Xiaoyuan Yi, Xing Xie · Main conference paper

ABSTRACT COUPLE represents value dimensions, dependencies, and priorities in a structural causal model, then uses counterfactual generation to steer an LLM toward specified value combinations. Tests on two value systems report gains over comparison methods.

SUMMARY Pluralism is modeled as structured trade-offs rather than a flat, equally weighted list. The causal representation also makes steering more inspectable, though evidence is benchmark-based.

PAPER https://arxiv.org/abs/2510.18526v2

Deep Value Benchmark: Measuring Whether Models Generalize Deep Values or Shallow Preferences

Joshua Ashkinaze, Hua Shen, Saipranav Avula, Eric Gilbert, Ceren Budak · Spotlight / poster

ABSTRACT DVB correlates moral principles with superficial style during training, then breaks that correlation at test time. Across nine models, the reported average deep-value generalization rate is 0.30; all tested systems performed below chance.

SUMMARY A diagnostic test of whether preference learning captures a principle or a shortcut. Low scores warn that apparently aligned training behavior may not survive distribution shift.

PAPER https://neurips.cc/virtual/2025/loc/san-diego/poster/117130

VENUE 02

AAAI-26 — 40th Annual AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence

DATE
20–27 January 2026

LOCATION
Singapore EXPO, Singapore

ORGANIZING / SPONSORING BODY
Association for the Advancement of Artificial Intelligence (AAAI)

VENUE RECORD
Open source

Broad AI conference with technical tracks, special tracks, bridges, tutorials, and workshops. The papers below are from the main proceedings.

FGD-Align: Pluralistic Alignment for Large Language Models via Fuzzy Group Decision-Making

Weihang Pan, Zhengxu Yu, Yong Wu, Xun Liang, Zhongming Jin, Qiang Fu, Penghui Shang, Binbin Lin, Xiaofei He, Jieping Ye · Humans and AI track

ABSTRACT FGD-Align models conflicting feedback with fuzzy preferences, combines within-group consensus with cross-group aggregation, and incorporates preference strength into probabilistic fuzzy DPO. Experiments report higher accuracy, robustness, and minority-preference preservation.

SUMMARY Its central advance is an explicit aggregation design for disagreement—useful where annotator conflict is signal rather than noise.

PAPER https://ojs.aaai.org/index.php/AAAI/article/view/38819

Multi-Value Alignment for LLMs via Value Decorrelation and Extrapolation

Hao Xu, Li Wu, Chao Cheng, Hui Liu · NLP technical track

ABSTRACT The method targets simultaneous alignment to multiple values by separating value representations to reduce interference and extrapolating across value directions. Reported experiments show gains over comparison methods.

SUMMARY Addresses a practical multi-objective failure mode: improving one value can entangle or degrade another.

PAPER https://ojs.aaai.org/index.php/AAAI/article/view/40708

VENUE 02 · CONTINUED

AAAI-26 — 40th Annual AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence

Belief-Driven Value Alignment for Human-Robot Collaboration

Shichao Li, Bowen Shi, Yuchen Xia, Xiaobing Su · Humans and AI track

ABSTRACT The paper links a robot's belief state to value alignment in collaborative tasks. Its belief-driven method improves alignment between human and robot beliefs, with experiments reporting better value-aligned collaboration.

> **SUMMARY** Shows that values alignment is not only an LLM post-training problem: embodied collaboration depends on accurately modeling human beliefs and intent.

PAPER https://ojs.aaai.org/index.php/AAAI/article/view/38809

Scaling Up AI Alignment

Amit Singh · Senior Member Presentation

ABSTRACT This senior-member paper surveys the shift from handcrafted expert systems to self-supervised models and frames scalable human feedback as a central bottleneck for alignment with individual expectations and societal norms.

> **SUMMARY** Best used as a conceptual map linking value elicitation, feedback efficiency, and social-scale aggregation.

PAPER https://ojs.aaai.org/index.php/AAAI/article/view/41335

VENUE 03

ICLR 2026 — 14th International Conference on Learning Representations

DATE
23–27 April 2026

LOCATION
Riocentro Convention and Event Center, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

ORGANIZING / SPONSORING BODY
International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)

VENUE RECORD
Open source

Major representation-learning conference using open peer review. Selected papers focus on behavioral measurement and personalized reward learning.

LitmusValues: Will AI Tell Lies to Save Sick Children? Litmus-Testing AI Values Prioritization with AIRiskDilemmas

Yu Ying Chiu, Zhilin Wang, Sharan Maiya, Yejin Choi, Kyle Fish, Sydney Levine, Evan Hubinger · Main conference paper

ABSTRACT LitmusValues measures revealed rather than stated priorities. AIRiskDilemmas places values in tension across contextualized risk scenarios; aggregate choices produce rankings that the authors report can predict included and held-out risky behaviors.

SUMMARY Turns abstract values into behavior under trade-off. It is valuable because model self-description may diverge from action, although dilemma construction simplifies moral context.

PAPER https://openreview.net/pdf/be679119bd5cae75857825cbe8a85e18e8155ce9.pdf

Learning to Summarize User Information for Personalized Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback

Hyunji Nam, Yanming Wan, Mickel Liu, Peter Ahnn, Jianxun Lian, Natasha Jaques · Main conference paper

ABSTRACT PLUS jointly trains a user-summary model and reward model. Text summaries of preferences and prior interactions condition predictions. Reported gains include 11–77% higher reward-model accuracy in tested settings and better transfer to new users and topics.

SUMMARY Offers a readable, user-controllable representation of personalization instead of compressing everyone into one reward model. Accuracy, consent, and revision of summaries remain governance questions.

PAPER https://arxiv.org/abs/2507.13579v3

VENUE 03 · CONTINUED

ICLR 2026 — 14th International Conference on Learning Representations

EigenBench: A Comparative Behavioral Measure of Value Alignment

Jonathn Chang, Leonhard Piff, Suvadip Sana, Jasmine X. Li, Lionel Levine · Oral presentation

ABSTRACT EigenBench compares models against a constitution without objective labels. Models judge one another across scenarios and EigenTrust aggregates the judgments; human comparisons and recovery of GPQA rankings serve as validation checks.

SUMMARY Pragmatic for values with legitimate disagreement. Its strength is label-free comparison; its risk is circularity when the judging ensemble shares blind spots.

PAPER https://arxiv.org/abs/2509.01938v3

VENUE 04

Lifelong Agents: Learning, Aligning, Evolving — ICLR 2026 Workshop

DATE
26 April 2026

LOCATION
Rio de Janeiro, Brazil (co-located with ICLR 2026)

ORGANIZING / SPONSORING BODY
Workshop organizers under the ICLR workshop program

VENUE RECORD
Open source

Workshop on agents that learn and change over extended interaction. ICLR workshops were held 26–27 April; the papers identify this workshop in their records.

Asymmetric Goal Drift in Coding Agents Under Value Conflict

Magnus Saebo, Spencer Gibson, Tyler Crosse, Achyutha Menon, Eyon Jang, Diogo Cruz · Workshop paper

ABSTRACT Coding agents complete multi-step tasks under explicit value constraints, with or without competing environmental pressure. Tested systems drift asymmetrically and more often violate instructions opposing learned security or privacy preferences; pressure compounds over context.

SUMMARY Learned values can protect against bad requests but also override legitimate constraints. Long-horizon evaluation is essential.

PAPER https://arxiv.org/abs/2603.03456v2

Lifelong Contextual Safety Alignment at Test Time for Multi-Modal LLMs

Ce Zhang, Jinxi He, Junyi He, Katia Sycara, Yaqi Xie · Workshop paper

ABSTRACT The paper introduces paired safe/unsafe image-text cases in MM-SafetyBench++ and EchoSafe, a training-free method that stores and retrieves self-reflective safety insights. Experiments report better context-sensitive safety while retaining helpfulness.

SUMMARY Treats alignment as continual inference-time learning. The paired benchmark detects over-refusal; memory quality, contamination, and correction remain deployment issues.

PAPER http://openreview.net/pdf?id=UtVQuX9rEs

VENUE 05

ACM FAccT 2026 — Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency

DATE
25–28 June 2026

LOCATION
Montréal, Québec, Canada

ORGANIZING / SPONSORING BODY
Association for Computing Machinery (ACM)

VENUE RECORD
Open source

Interdisciplinary conference spanning computing, law, social science, and humanities. The selected paper appeared in a pluralistic-alignment session.

What Do People Actually Want From AI? Mapping Preference Plurality

Julia Sepúlveda Coelho, Scott A. Hale · Peer-reviewed conference paper

ABSTRACT Analysis of 1,500 open-ended responses from 75 countries finds most values requested by fewer than one quarter of respondents. Truthfulness was most common but defined incompatibly; human-likeness and guardrails were directly contested.

SUMMARY Challenges the premise that one averaged reward captures public values. Even shared labels can hide distinct normative expectations.

PAPER https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.06674v1

VENUE 06

AIES 2026 — 9th AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society

DATE
12–14 October 2026 (forthcoming as of the 10 October cutoff)

LOCATION
Malmö, Sweden

ORGANIZING / SPONSORING BODY
AAAI and ACM

VENUE RECORD
Open source

Included because the selected paper was accepted and public before the event; the conference itself falls two days after the review cutoff.

AI Alignment and Fiduciary Obligation

Benjamin Lange · Accepted paper; conference forthcoming

ABSTRACT The paper argues that extended assistant relationships should be evaluated through developer duties to users. Loyalty, care, good faith, and candour are mapped to risks in the user–AI–developer relationship, with proposed institutional measures.

SUMMARY Reframes alignment from selecting model values to defining enforceable obligations for the organization controlling the system. Normative rather than an empirical performance study.

PAPER https://arxiv.org/abs/2608.02660v2

CROSS-VENUE SYNTHESIS

Where the field is converging

Pluralism is moving from principle to mechanism

COUPLE, FGD-Align, PLUS, and the FAccT preference study reject the assumption that one population-average reward is sufficient. They operationalize pluralism through causal value structures, fuzzy aggregation, user summaries, or direct study of disagreement.

Behavioral tests are replacing self-report

LitmusValues, DVB, and EigenBench measure choices, generalization, or comparative behavior. Stated values and training-set fit are weak evidence unless the intended principle survives conflict and distribution shift.

Alignment is increasingly temporal

The Lifelong Agents papers show both that constraints can drift as context accumulates and that safety memories can improve contextual judgment. Static first-turn evaluation misses both failure and adaptation.

Governance is part of the technical object

FAccT and AIES move beyond model behavior to participation, interpretation, and developer obligation. Aggregation rules and institutional duties determine whose values count.

Recommended reading order

1. **DVB** for deep versus shallow value learning.
2. **Mapping Preference Plurality** for evidence that users disagree.
3. **FGD-Align** and **PLUS** for aggregation and personalization.
4. **LitmusValues** and **Asymmetric Goal Drift** for conflict and time.
5. **AI Alignment and Fiduciary Obligation** for accountability.

APPENDIX · OUTSIDE STRICT WINDOW

ICLR 2025 Workshop on Bidirectional Human–AI Alignment

DATE
28 April 2025

LOCATION
Singapore EXPO, Singapore

WHY INCLUDED
Direct predecessor to current pluralistic and bidirectional work

VENUE RECORD
Open source

Value Alignment in the Global South: A Multidimensional Approach to Norm Elicitation in Indian Contexts

Atmadeep Ghoshal, Martim Brandão, Ruba Abu-Salma

ABSTRACT Combines social-justice theory and thick description to design context-sensitive norm elicitation with Dalit and Adivasi communities, emphasizing historical power and meaningful participation.

https://openreview.net/pdf/cb84a2b6c6d28b8eefc52aef505abe26072f7aa2.pdf

Processing, Priming, and Probing: Human Interventions for Explainability Alignment

See workshop paper

ABSTRACT Classifies human intervention in explanations as post-hoc processing, prior-knowledge priming, or interactive probing while emphasizing fidelity to model behavior.

https://openreview.net/pdf/0c1c3bc593619ae86f7d6ef52fdf5bef106c2c2a.pdf

Superalignment with Dynamic Human Values

Florian Mai, David Kaczér, Nicholas Kluge Corrêa, Lucie Flek

ABSTRACT Sketches a scalable-oversight roadmap in which complex tasks are decomposed so human guidance can remain relevant as systems and values change.

https://florianmai.github.io/collection-archive/

SOURCES & LIMITATIONS

Research notes

This is a selective review, not an exhaustive bibliometric census. Adjacent work may use “preference alignment,” “AI safety,” or “responsible AI” differently.

Method

Venue facts were checked against organizer or conference records where available. Paper status was checked against proceedings, official program pages, OpenReview, or author-posted records. Every abstract is a fresh paraphrase.

Use with care

- Workshop papers may be non-archival or earlier-stage.
- Accepted papers for future events are labeled.
- Performance numbers are authors’ reported results, not independent replications.
- “Sponsoring organization” means the governing association or foundation, not the full commercial sponsor roster.

Linked records · A

NeurIPS 2025 — 39th Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems
https://intuitionlabs.ai/articles/neurips-2025-conference-summary-trends

Counterfactual Reasoning for Steerable Pluralistic Value Alignment of Large Language Models
https://arxiv.org/abs/2510.18526v2

Deep Value Benchmark: Measuring Whether Models Generalize Deep Values or Shallow Preferences
https://neurips.cc/virtual/2025/loc/san-diego/poster/117130

AAAI-26 — 40th Annual AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence
https://aaai.org/conference/aaai/aaai-26/become-a-sponsor/

FGD-Align: Pluralistic Alignment for Large Language Models via Fuzzy Group Decision-Making
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https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/research/event/iclr-2026/

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SOURCES · CONTINUED

Linked records · B

Lifelong Agents: Learning, Aligning, Evolving — ICLR 2026 Workshop
https://blog.iclr.cc/2026/01/13/iclr2026-workshops/

Asymmetric Goal Drift in Coding Agents Under Value Conflict
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Lifelong Contextual Safety Alignment at Test Time for Multi-Modal LLMs
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ACM FAccT 2026 — Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency
https://www.oii.ox.ac.uk/oii-researchers-head-to-facct-2026/

What Do People Actually Want From AI? Mapping Preference Plurality
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AIES 2026 — 9th AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society
https://aaai.org/conference/aies/

AI Alignment and Fiduciary Obligation
https://arxiv.org/abs/2608.02660v2

BiAlign 2025 workshop
https://iclr.cc/virtual/2025/workshop/23986

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https://openreview.net/pdf/0c1c3bc593619ae86f7d6ef52fdf5bef106c2c2a.pdf

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